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Virginia Board of Education, Lab Schools Standing Committee, Monday, March 4, 2024

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[00:00:00] Well, welcome to the March 2024 meeting of the College Partnership Laboratory School Standing Committee. First, the committee would like to thank the University of Virginia UVA for their hospitality and hosting us on site today.

[00:00:18] Thank you very much for doing that, especially during spring break. spring break. I will note that I've approved the remote participation of Mr. Bill Hanson under the board's bylaws section 2.2 3708.3 B3 of the code of Virginia as such participation is allowed because his principal residence is more than 60 miles from the median location identified in the notice. Dr. Armstrong, please call the role of the members of the standing committee. Yes, ma'am.

[00:00:46] Chair Winiska. Present. Vice Chair Moran. Present. Mr. Bailey. Mr. Hanson. Mr. Ross. Present. Thank you. At this time, if you'd please join me in a moment of silence, and then we will proceed with our approval of the agenda. All right. At this time, the members of the scanning committee were provided an amended agenda in advance of the meeting. Is there a motion to approve the amended agenda?

[00:01:31] is there a second second all those in favor of approving the amended agenda please signify by saying aye aye any opposed nay aye okay okay all right the motion is unanimously approved and we'll proceed with our uh consideration today all right now we'll prove to the approval of the minutes is there a

motion to approve the minutes as presented to the standing committee so moved is there a second second all those in favor of the motion please signify by saying aye aye

[00:02:06] the chair votes out as well any opposed the motion is unanimously approved at this point in the agenda we typically take public comment on the agenda items at this time there's no public comment but i do want to just share again on behalf of the standing committee we accept public comment on all matters related to the college partnership laboratory schools in virginia public comment is an important consideration and valued input to the standing committee and given the time and cost to travel and again for the benefit of the public record the standing committee always welcomes and encourages the public to either submit written comment or to certainly participate

[00:02:43] remotely and to provide that comment to us and mr hansen just logged in thank you very much and the committee i want to note for the record for the benefit of everyone in the room and listening online that Mr. Hansen has joined the committee deliberations as well. Good morning Mr. Hansen.

[00:03:00] Good morning. As we begin today's deliberation, I want to acknowledge the recent Senate and House budget language, the ongoing budget deliberations between the Governor and the General Assembly, and the questions that this has prompted from applicants and the public. The committee will receive an update on lab schools including the budget language under item D. As part of this update on behalf of the committee dr armstrong and i will review the committee's process to consider public lab school applications clarify terminology such as what's the difference between the lab

[00:03:38] application under review one that's pending or one that's been approved we'll also provide information on the approved public lab schools and an update on the lab school applications received to date as part of our usual pipeline update as members of the standing committee our role is to develop procedures for receiving reviewing and ruling on lab school applications from virginia's colleges and universities and to advise the state board they are in since day one the committee members have dispatched this duty with great care creating a rigorous high quality

[00:04:18] and deliberative process the standing committee's focus has been on durable financially sustainable locally supported public lab schools that adhere to all applicable state and federal laws and that afford high quality student-led public options. In total, 21 higher education institutions from across the commonwealth have submitted lab school applications. To date, four applications have earned the committee's support and been referred to and approved by the State Board of Education.

[00:04:55] today is part of our regularly scheduled monthly meeting the committee will consider three pending lab school applications and with this i want to welcome our three pending lab school applications to today's meeting congratulations on getting to this point in the process which we truly do appreciate how hard this work is so let's begin item a is second and final review of college partnership lab school application from mountain gateway community college the committee will hear from Dr. Wirth and Ms. Tamara Lipscomb from Mountain Gateway Community College followed by

[00:05:33] Dr. Armstrong who will provide a staff report. After Mountain Gateway speaks Dr. Armstrong will provide his report and we'll certainly have time for Q&A from the committee. So at this time Dr. Wirth and Ms. Lipscomb please proceed with your prepared presentation. Thank you for that introduction and I want to thank the laboratory school standing committee for hearing us today.

[00:05:55] Our application is generating a lot of buzz here in the Allegheny Highlands and across the southern Shenandoah Valley, which is the area that we serve. I'd like to recognize other members from Mountain Gateway Community College here today. Joining us is College President John Renoni. Good morning, everyone. Thank you for having us again.

[00:06:15] Also joining us is Alex Morrow. He is our planning grant director. Alex? Yes. Hi, everybody. I appreciate you supporting the remote call, but it's wonderful to be here. Super excited about the lab school to see the progress that we're going to make in the future.

[00:06:37] And also joining me is Tamara Lipscomb, and she'll be helping me with the presentation. Good morning. I do have a PowerPoint. Would you like me to share that? Or is that PowerPoint also on your screen as well?

[00:06:54] So I will move forward to the second slide, partner high schools. Hold tight. One minute, Dr. Worth. I'll go ahead and get it on the screen. We're going to get this all squared up for you.

[00:07:09] Sure. And while you're doing that, I wouldn't, since I've got the opportunity to talk to the committee, one thing I'm really proud of is the work that we've done coordinating with our local high schools, as well as business and industry here in Allegheny Highlands and Canandoah Valley. We have support from all of our high schools in the area. So we serve Allegheny County, Bath County, Rockbridge County, and the northern half of Botetourt County.

[00:07:47] And the school systems in those areas are supporting us. We've had great conversations with superintendents and principals. We also have support from our local chambers of commerce in all these areas, as well as support from business and industry. So it's been a real collaborative process. And one of the things that this school is really going to be able to do is take the IT instruction that is already happening in our local schools, but take it to a much, much better level where we'll be able to provide students leaving high schools with significant industry-recognized certifications where they can go out straight to work with those certifications and also provide

[00:08:26] with pathways on to additional study and two-year and four-year institutions. So let's see. With that, let's move to our industry partners, which I'll leave this up. Yeah, industry partners. Thank you. So we've been working closely with the Virginia Military Institute. They have a cyber defense lab that's been supportive of us, the Connelly Center for Entrepreneurship at Washington and Lee University. Amazon Web Services has been a supporter of the Virginia Community College system and curriculum development so that the curriculum that we use to teach our cloud computing

[00:09:01] courses was developed through them Cengage is a national leader on providing educational materials they are providing and have agreed to provide a discount on those materials to our students and we're starting to build oh and CompTIA they they provide discounts on certification vouchers they also provide professional development support for the faculty who will be teaching these courses

[00:09:26] And we're starting to build more and more partners, such as Cirlian Rockridge Community Hospital, which will be locations where our students will be able to do internships and get some experiential learning, which is one component of our lab school that we're really excited about.

[00:09:44] Next slide, please. One of the things we're really excited about is a flexible delivery of our course content. So this will allow our students to come to our campus face-to-face, learn in a brick-and-mortar location.

[00:10:00] We have, and with the funding we hope to receive, we'll have an excellent first-grade laboratory experience for our students. We realize that some of our students may have conflicts with travel. The area we serve is large geographically.

[00:10:16] Some of our students may have to travel up to 45 minutes or more to come to the main campus of Mountain Gateway Community College to do the laboratory school, so we will be providing support through Zoom for students who need to get live action, just like we have here today, and we also have asynchronous support as well.

[00:10:35] So if there's a student who's not able to come to campus or is not even able to get to the Zoom section, we have, through our learning management system, we use a system called Canvas. We're able to provide access to all of the educational content so the students won't fall behind if there's any problems with travel coming to our campus.

[00:10:56] We've been instrumental in delivering HyFlex instruction here on our campus for several years now, going back even before the pandemic. and we're excited to be able to deliver this to high school students as well as part of this laboratory school. Next slide, please, and I'll let Tamara Lipscomb, our information systems technology program head, talk to you a little bit more about the different technology pathways we are planning. Good morning again. So on this slide, you'll see that we have three areas, and you know we hear especially of cybersecurity and cloud computing every day. Those are two terms

[00:11:31] that a lot of people you know they know cyber security they know we have to be uh safe and secure but they don't really think about what it means so cyber security professionals could either be in a role where they're in cyber defense or cyber offense and those cyber defense professionals protect our organizations from evolving threats safeguarding our sensitive data and systems from breaches and attacks as well as providing incident response when something you know unfortunate does occur on the other side we have cyber professionals who are ethical hackers and they help those defensive professionals find and mitigate those vulnerabilities here at mg tech we provide

[00:12:09] comprehensive training that focuses on both offensive and defensive practices because we believe that it professionals need to understand both offensive and defensive tactics to provide a truly secure infrastructure this career path as you probably already imagine offers top pay and dynamic challenges to folks daily so that is a big draw to the field cloud computing another one we hear all the time it is a delivery of computing services that includes servers storage databases networking software and analytics over the internet and now that internet is commonly referred

[00:12:46] to as the cloud so this offers increased innovation flexible resources and economies of scale cloud computing has really revolutionized business operations so this pretty much equates to those specialists earning top pay as they drive that digital transformation that we just talked about by designing and managing cloud infrastructure again that economies of scale that we just talked about both of these career paths excellent pay and opportunity for remote work which is essential to our our service area lastly you see it technical support these professionals in it

[00:13:25] technical support roles. They provide that frontline assistance for seamless IT operations. They troubleshoot the technical issues, ensure systems function smoothly, and their prompt attention to these issues reduce downtime for businesses. So it's a very, very important career path. This career path is often where the most growth happens for an IT professional, and it is really an amazing entry point for anyone

aspiring to go into IT. It provides a solid foundation, and it opens doors to other opportunities and more specialized area. This career, this option

[00:14:00] actually can be a career on its own, or it can blossom into a more specialized role. If you can think of any business right now, from our hospitals to our real estate offices, anywhere you can think of banks, they need frontline support. And that's what we kind of refer to as our feet on the street folks. So these folks could provide remote assistance or they could be local. Next slide, please. In our lab school design, we have three levels, three years, but three entry points really.

[00:14:35] So as you can kind of see from this slide, it's ideal for our students to begin their program in their sophomore year by taking a course in digital and information literacy, and that ensures that have the skills needed for at more advanced classes next they dive into programming which is really essential for any it path and we've chosen python programming because it seems to fit it many areas of it the most now in their second year they'll start focusing on industry certifications and preparing for one of those three choices paths that we just saw and they could actually

[00:15:10] choose more than one path this arrangement of course work does allow for a late starting entry into our lab school so if a student didn't get to enter in their sophomore year they can jump right in on their junior year and then on their last year students are immersed in more advanced courses and are preparing for more industry certifications this design actually allows for differentiated learning by allowing advanced students to pursue more certifications while providing the time to mentor and prepare students who might need additional support in addition to this given curriculum students will also have an opportunity to participate in enrichment activities to explore

[00:15:48] the material more deeply in a more applied manner and some of those examples include maybe capture the flag events listening to industry speakers and taking field trips next slide thank you the certifications that we mentioned are here on your screen as you already have heard CompTIA is an industry leader in certifications we are a CompTIA partner And we're also a designated Cisco Networking Academy.

[00:16:13] It's through these partnerships that we can bring high quality materials and certification opportunities to our students. And again, what's on your screen here? These are some of the most highly sought after certifications by employers. As we draw this to a close, I really want to emphasize the opportunity for creating meaningful careers for the students that will be serving through MG Tech.

[00:16:38] The average salary in the Allegheny Highlands is $60,000 a year. That's $24,000 less than the national average of $80,000 a year. You can see listed here the average starting salaries for careers that students exiting this program with those certifications in place could hope to earn.

[00:17:01] And those are jobs that are available both through businesses in our service area, but also businesses statewide and nationally, allowing for remote learning for students to do that kind of work. So we're really excited to be able to provide a real meaningful stepping stone for the students here in our service area.

[00:17:20] With that, I'd like to answer any questions that the committee may have about the MGTAC proposal. Thank you, Dr. Worth and Ms. Lipscomb. Before we proceed with committee questions, I do want to note that John Bailey has also joined us remotely, and I have approved the remote participation of Mr. Bailey under the board's bylaws, section 2.2.3708.3B3 of the Code of Virginia.

[00:17:49] such participation is allowed because his principal residence is more than 60 miles from the meeting location identified in the notice. So with that I'll open it up to questions from committee members if there are any questions. I just have one and that is that I always thank you. I keep coming back to how do we make sure that students prior to 10th grade are going to be able to have opportunities that open those pathways? Because too often what we find is that some kids get those

[00:18:23] experiences and others don't. And I'm wondering how you see building out opportunities, perhaps starting as early as middle school for students. Thank you for that question. And one thing you'll see in our full application is a summer camp. We've currently run this already in partnership with the cyber patriot camp so this is a summer camp opportunity for students that would be in middle school and or early high school that would have a fun on-campus experience where they learn about cyber security and uh tamra i might let you say a little bit more about the cyber

[00:19:01] patriot camp but it's a great way to get students who are middle school interested in these kinds of opportunities that way students in their freshman year can be can learn more about our our laboratory school proposal so they'll be ready to start as sophomores yeah i can uh tell you our lab score our math score cyber security uh cyber patriot camp over the summer was very successful students love it because it's very hands-on it's not just listening about the material but it's it's learning something in the going and hands-on apply it and the last day ends with a competition

[00:19:36] against other cyber patriot campers throughout the nation so it really is a wonderful opportunity to get kids really ingrained and hands-on. Thank you for that. Thank you. That's a fantastic proposal that we're really excited about and one of the things you talked about is just how leading edge it is in terms of jobs and opportunities for kids. I just have one question. I just want to make sure we're all clear. It talks about Mountain Gateways Community College's very admirable commitment to lowering financial barriers for kids to participate and a really inclusive approach there.

[00:20:13] i just want to make sure we're crystal that that's lowering barriers in this case for things like obviously setting up the testing center so that the tests are available test fees that may come with some of these some of these credentials and so forth this is not these are this is a public school that's open to all kids regardless of financial circumstances i just want to make sure just to clarify that with you before we move forward yes and i can say that uh definitively uh yes it will be open to all of our to all the students in our service area regardless of ability to pay uh that's something that um mg tech will take very seriously something the mountain gateway

[00:20:49] community college it takes very seriously to make sure we have an equal access opportunity for all of our students thank you questions from other committee members i have one clarifying question as well uh in the section on the lottery process there's a term used as a modifier to students it it's qualified students and in our feedback to the applicants and in other places in the application it denotes that the mountain gateway tech will use a lottery system and it will be open to all

[00:21:27] students so again i'm just clarifying that could you please restate is the school open to all students or qualified students it is open to all students um they would you know need to be qualified in the sense that they are uh residents of our service area um and um uh enrolled in well i think i think that's uh the the the key point there is that they they meet our residency requirement thank you all right hearing no further uh deliberation on this item i'm going

[00:22:07] to turn it over to dr armstrong to provide the staff report on this application thank you madam Chair and members of the committee. I am pleased to provide you with this overview of the now reviewed Mountain Gateway Community College Technology Education Center MG Tech Lab School proposal, a partnership among Mountain Gateway Community College, Rockbridge County Public Schools, Buena Vista City Public Schools, Bath County Public Schools, Allegheny Highlands Public Schools, and Botetourt County Public Schools. The goals of MG Tech, which include providing high school

[00:22:42] students with a comprehensive education in information technology, including cybersecurity, AWS cloud computing, and IT support, preparing students for IT careers by offering courses that lead to career studies certificates, providing a springboard to an associate's degree in IT, providing knowledge and skills necessary to obtain industry-leading certifications by providing hands-on project-based learning opportunities that will allow students to develop the skills and knowledge they need to succeed in the field, are responsive to the local need to provide support to students served by MGTECH to establish exposure and earn credentials that lead to high-wage,

[00:23:18] high-skill, high-demand jobs in the IT and cybersecurity industry. That, importantly, would potentially allow students to remain in the region served by Mountain Gateway Community College, a region that hopes to improve the overall workforce demand and retention conditions.

[00:23:33] Students enrolled in MGTECH will be served in a program based on the HyFlex model, which provides students with the choice of learning modalities, including synchronous online learning, asynchronous learning, and in-person learning. This approach will allow students to personalize their learning experience based on their individual styles, preferences, and needs, and curriculum innovations that leverage other existing programs in the students-based school. The curriculum unfolds over three dynamic years, each building upon the previous to create a scaffold learning experience, which is purely based on the goals of the computer science standards of learning. In years one and two, students are, as you have seen, exposed to

[00:24:09] Python programming, digital literacy, computer applications, and specialized modules in networking, PC hardware, and OS architecture before year three when students have the unique opportunities to select a concentration in either cybersecurity, IT support, or AWS cloud computing.

[00:24:26] The VDOE received the access, I'm sorry, the MG Tech Academy application on July 12, 2023. In their intervening eight months, the agency has collaborated with the applicant as follows. During the week of August 14, 2023, the subject matter expert team provided detailed feedback in each compliance-related section of the application. The goal of the Application Review Technical Expert Committee is to document the needed technical expertise and provide counseling to the applicants to identify and correct any potential deficiencies in the planning and implementation of the proposed laboratory school, determine compliance with state law

[00:25:03] regulation, highlight potential problems or red flags with information contained in the application, and to identify aspects of the proposal that are especially exciting or unique. The subject matter expert team includes myself, Mr. Rob Gilstrat from the Office of Licensure and School Leadership, Mr. Jason Ellis from the Office of Accountability, Mr. Rebecca Askey from the Office of Policy, Mr. Ed Lanza from the Office of Budgeting and Finance, Ms. Melissa Velasquez from the Department of Policy and Communications, Dr. Samantha Hollis from the Department of Special Education and Student Services, and Dr. Dave Myers from the Office of Data Research and Technology.

[00:25:38] Each subject matter expert was provided with the Laboratory School Criteria Checklist Worksheet. Areas of expertise are assigned to various staff subject to their expertise at the VDOE, and a compilation of those comments is included in the spreadsheet and is attached to the agenda entitled the VDOE Completance and Compliance Report.

[00:25:56] The Completance and Compliance Report corresponds to the application and reflects the following dimensions of compliance: executive summary, mission and vision, educational program, governance, management structure, financial operations, placement plan, and other assurances. The applicant, Mountain Gateway Community College, was responsive to subject matter experts' feedback and questions and provided extra application and addendums as required to meet compliance. Items of required attention by the applicant included additional details related to SOL and NGTECH curriculum alignment, teacher and leadership employment policies, provision of extracurricular activities to NGTECH students, additional clarification related to food service

[00:26:35] provisions and a complete startup table. A revised application was submitted to the VDOE on September 10, 2023, and a subsequent technical assistance call was held on September 18, 2023. On October 19, 2023, an on-site technical assistance visit was held on the MGCC campus, and a further revised application was received on November 27, 2023. The VDOE SME review team provided additional feedback on that application revision during the week of December 6, and MGCC was provided with the results

[00:27:08] of the review team feedback on December 13. They provided a revised application again to the VDOE for first standing committee review consideration on December 20, 2023. On January 8, the MGTEC team presented for first review to the standing committee, responded to questions of the committee, and was approved by the standing committee on January 8 to proceed to today's second standing committee review. The MG Tech Academy application was posted for public comment following the January 8th standing committee meeting on January 18th and remained available for public comment until February 1st. The following comment was received, quote, the addition of the Mountain

[00:27:47] Gateway Lab School will greatly benefit our region by giving students an opportunity to gain the skills and certification for employment in an educational model that fits their individual needs. The skills and certifications the students earn will allow them to stay in the region with a high earning career. In preparation for today's second standing committee review, the NG Tech team provided additional edits to their application in response to feedback received during first standing committee review. It is also noted that NG Tech, unlike other lab school applicants that we have considered up to this point, is employing dedicated higher ed faculty to teach NG Tech dual enrollment coursework. While this is common and acceptable throughout

[00:28:26] dual enrollment programs across the Commonwealth, the lab school statute is more specific and it's requirement that a lab school teacher be employed by the higher ed institution and only valid K-12 Virginia teacher license. Administrative code and its definitions of Virginia teacher licenses does include a dual enrollment or CTE license that would appear to satisfy the statutory requirement on behalf of MGTAC and any lab school with a similar model. We anticipate being able to work with Mountain Gateway prior to BOE approval or consideration to resolve this with more formalized NOTICE. ON BEHALF OF THE VDOES SUBMIT THAT THE MOUNTAIN GATEWAY COMMUNITY COLLEGE MG TECH LAB

[00:29:03] SCHOOL IS COMPLIANT AND READY TO IMPLEMENT AND I RECOMMEND TO THE COMMITTEE THAT THE MG TECH LAB SCHOOL BE APPROVED ON SECOND REVIEW TO BE

FORWARDED TO THE VIRGINIA BOARD OF EDUCATION FOR THEIR CONSIDERATION FOR APPROVAL AT THEIR MARCH 28, 2024 MEETING. DR. ARMSTRONG, THANK YOU FOR THAT SUMMARY AND CERTAINLY FOR THE COMMITTEE'S RIGOROUS AND THOROUGH REVIEW OF THIS APPLICATION.

[00:29:25] AT THIS TIME, ARE THERE ANY QUESTIONS FOR DR. ARMSTRONG REGARDING THE STAFF REPORT? Dr. Armstrong, I just have one question. With the impending implementation of the data science standards, was that something that y'all looked at as you were looking at this particular proposal, which is an information technology proposal? Yes, ma'am. I know that Mr. Ellis, who is a subject matter expert who has joined our team in the accountability space, does look at that in IN THEIR ALIGNMENT WITH OUR STANDARDS, AND I KNOW THAT WAS A CONSIDERATION IN HIS REVIEW.

[00:30:03] GREAT QUESTION. ANY OTHER QUESTIONS FOR DR. HARMSTROM? ALL RIGHT. IS THERE A MOTION TO APPROVE MOUNTAIN GATEWAY COMMUNITY COLLEGE APPLICATION ON SECOND REVIEW AND TO REFER THE APPLICATION TO THE VIRGINIA STATE BOARD OF EDUCATION FOR APPROVAL? SO MOVED. IS THERE A SECOND? SECOND.

[00:30:23] ALL THOSE IN FAVOR, PLEASE SIGNIFY BY SAYING AYE. CHAIR VOTES AYE AS WELL. MR. HANSEN VOTES AYE. the motion any opposed please signify by saying nay let the record note there are there is no opposition the motion unanimously passes congratulations mountain gateway your application will be forwarded to the state board of education on behalf of the committee i direct the staff to finalize the report with bdoes and the standing committee's deliberation and to compile that report along with the application and all material received by the standing committee and to refer mountain gateway community college application to the board of education for

[00:31:02] consideration at next public meeting all right that concludes consideration of item a we'll now move to item b which is second and final review of the college partnership lab school application from the university of virginia the committee will hear from dr wilkins education outreach director from uva and she will be joined by her team from uva she's coaxing them up here to the front um i've asked Dr. Wilkins, she has a prepared statement that she will read on behalf of the university.

[00:31:42] Oh, please feel free to join us up here. And following her statement, the members of her team are invited to please state your name, your role with the lab school or with the institution. Is that good? That's great. And Claire and for IT, would you prefer that Dr. Wilkins stand at the podium so that she can be heard or is this adequate where she stands?

[00:32:08] Let's go to the podium just to make sure everyone can hear what you have to say. Sounds good. Okay. All right. Thank you. So Madam Chair and members of the committee, on behalf of University of Virginia and the Charlotte School of City Lab Schools, planning committee members, including those here today, we want to thank you for the opportunity to present and share our UVA Innovation Hub at Charlotte School Middle School lab school application.

[00:32:32] We also want to recognize the important role that Dr. Armstrong played in helping us bring our vision to you. In the latest revisions to our application, we address feedback from you and the subject matter experts. For instance, we added more details to the staffing plan, incorporated additional human resource policies, and added an evaluation framework.

[00:32:53] We stand ready and excited to bring the mission of the UVA Innovation Hub to engage all students in personally meaningful, computationally rich, and interdisciplinary learning experiences to

life at Charlottesville Middle School. Thank you. - Dr. Wilkins, thank you again. thank you again to uva for hosting us at this time i'd like to allow each of your members to address the committee as well well thank you good morning everyone so first we're really honored to have the committee here with us today honored to host you all i'm really grateful for the feedback it's been a wonderful partnership and um in really improving the application um just want to

[00:33:32] acknowledge our Charlottesville City Schools partners. So I'm a newer, new-ish, maybe dean. You know, this is the end of my second year, and this idea really emanated out of my very first meeting with Dr. Royal Gurley, the superintendent there, and so it's been really wonderful over the course of the entire time that I've been here to bring this to fruition. I'm so really grateful to them and of course our team here who's done just so much work to get us to this point in developing curriculum and partnerships with the schools and uh and teachers etc so i'm really glad to be here

[00:34:10] and again grateful for your help hi i'm dr coffee from charlesville city schools i'm the coordinator of science and innovation i guess i gosh it goes all the way back to september 2022 my very first month at shallotsville city schools i get an email from dr chu and dr welkins and there is the journey um so a year and a half almost later we have this amazing innovation hub that is coming to fruition and i'm so excited for the students here and for the community and just everyone in

[00:34:45] general it's been amazing teamwork and we have something truly astonishing to show for it hello I'm Jenny Chu, I'm an associate professor of STEM education here at UVA, and I'll keep my comments brief. I just want to say thank you to the standing committee and Dr. Armstrong for all of their support to get us to this point, and again, just echoing the strong partnership with Charlottesville City Schools that has enabled us to get to this point. I'm very excited for this work to continue. Thank you all. At this time, are there any further questions for members of the

[00:35:23] standing committee on UVA's application? No, I just want to make an observation. I mean, this shows this application is different in some ways qualitatively than some of the others in terms of the thrust of the school the approach the pedagogy and that's a good thing i mean this this uh whole idea is about creating options for families for students to to sort of to have more more agency over choosing their own adventure as they move through in an environment of quality and and publicness and uh and so i think that's like a really good thing and i want to call that out relative to you know we have a number of schools in the pipeline with different approaches the school

[00:35:58] just we heard from mountain gateway school um uh earlier this morning as a different approach and and i just want to call attention that that's a that's a positive thing and will lead to both more options uh for families and it will lead to uh some learning here in the commonwealth any other further comments or questions i would just weigh in by saying that living in the community and watching the recent work that's occurred in charlotte city to reimagine the way that middle school is going to unfold that this is such a wonderful signature program that i think is going

[00:36:37] to really give life to a very different way of thinking about how do we educate middle school's children well so that they can go to high school have a great level of success graduate pursue all kinds of pathways and i believe that whether a student in this program intends to pursue when they graduate from high school a stem career or not that they will be better citizens better community members and better uh learners in whatever endeavor that they take on because there's really very few careers in this day and age that do not have stem embedded whether

[00:37:13] it's uh humanities the arts or the sciences so uh hats off to y'all for conceptualizing this and i can't wait to maybe get a chance to come visit any other takers okay i i do want to just weigh in on one more item and that is to say at the first meeting we had the opportunity to hear from the application you could visually see the partnership and collaboration the number of individuals that spoke at our first review of this application your community partners

[00:37:50] members of a local school division the intentional ecosystem that you have built for students and children is incredible and just to see that it was so powerful so i want to thank you for really knitting together so many local assets that could otherwise be unconnected or not fully utilized but really leveraging all those assets and bringing them to bear on this conversation for students benefit so thank you for doing that okay dr armstrong do you have a staff reporter

[00:38:28] on this item as well all right dr armstrong will walk us through the process that the video we went through on this application as well madam madam chair of your permission i will abridge this report slightly since i've included a lot of language about the subject matter expert team and how that works and i would like to also know before i begin these comments um another dimension of our work with the standing committee with the applicants is the effect it's going to have on teachers and i know that this will be not just the uva innovation hub mg tech our lab schools are going to make a better experience for our teachers as well so thank you all dean rowley especially

[00:39:07] for being here on behalf of the school of education uh measurement committee amaz budeska please provide you with this overview of the now reviewed university of virginia innovation hub at charlottesville middle school lab school proposal a partnership between the university of virginia and charlottesville city public schools the goals of the uva innovation hub at cms which include developing a community of practice around education that incorporates interdisciplinary project-based computationally rich learning experiences engaging students by incorporating their voices and choices throughout the learning process and making meaningful community connections to engage students teachers and families in real world problem solving mentorship and career

[00:39:45] explorations are responsive to the local needs as determined by the unique community problems of practice model implemented by Innovation Hub. Additionally, as noted in the UVA Innovation Hub application, by transforming school experiences in a way that elevates the developmental needs of young adolescents through student-driven community and design-based projects, the Lab School aims to elevate the voice and agency of middle school students in ways of aligned with research-based practices for positive youth development and asset-based pedagogy. This approach addresses current high-priority needs at CMS, which include increasing student engagement in school and in science, professional development

[00:40:23] that helps teachers connect different content areas in a way that is relevant to and builds on the assets of their students, and increasing student performance on state assessments. Students enrolled in the Innovation Hub, which will be housed primarily at Charlottesville Middle School and includes all middle school students eventually at CMS and in Charlottesville City Schools, will participate in the unique offerings of the Innovation Hub. The Lab School acts as a dynamic center for experiential learning where sixth grade students begin their middle school journey with a focus on exploring diverse interests and developing essential technical and real-world problem-solving skills. As students progress to seventh grade, they undertake two

[00:41:00] comprehensive interdisciplinary projects designed to provide practical experience and exposure to various industries, enhancing their understanding of real-world application of their studies. The culmination of this integrative lab school experience is seen in the eighth grade where students develop capstone projects. These projects represent a synthesis of their learning journey and prepare them for future academic and professional challenges. The VOE received the UVA Innovation Hub application on November 8, 2023, and in the intervening months, the HSC agency has collaborated with the applicant as follows. During the week of November 8, 2023, the subject

[00:41:36] matter expert team provided detailed feedback in each compliance-related section of the application. The applicant was responsive to subject matter experts' feedback and questions and provided edits to their application and addendums as required to meet compliance. The applicant responded with their edited application and addenda on December 21, 2023, which was subsequently reviewed by the subject matter experts on December 27, 2023. Once it was established that the applicant had provided satisfactory responses to the VDOE, the UVA Innovation Hub application was placed on the agenda for first standing committee review on February 5th, 2024. The UVA Innovation Hub team

[00:42:14] presented to the standing committee on February 5th, responded to questions of the committee, and was approved by the standing committee on February 5th to proceed to today's second standing committee review. The UVA Innovation Hub application was posted for public comment following the February 5th standing committee meeting on February 15th and remained available until March 1st, and the following comment was received: "A laboratory school for our city's middle schoolers would be an incredible opportunity for our children and community!

[00:42:42] My son, current third grader, would be so thrilled and excited to attend a school devoted to this passion. Please make this a reality in Charlottesville. In preparation for today's second standing committee review, the UVA Innovation Hub team provided additional edits, which you've heard about today, to their application in response to feedback received during first standing committee review. Items of required attention by the applicant included clarification of any alternative assessments other than SOLs to be used to measure progress under the educational program and clarification of time periods associated with staffing, evaluation of staff, HR policy, and partnerships under their management structure. On behalf of the BDOE, I submit that

[00:43:19] the UVA Innovation Hub at Charlottesville Middle School Lab School is compliant and ready to implement, and I recommend to the committee that the Innovation Hub be approved on second review to be forwarded to the Virginia Board of Education for their consideration for approval at the March 28 2024 meeting thank you dr armstrong are there any questions at this time for staff all right hearing none is there a motion to approve the university of virginia's application on second review and refer the application to the virginia state board of education for approval salute and

[00:43:53] is there a second second from mr hansen okay thank you mr hansen all right all those in favor of the motion please signify by saying aye aye chair votes aye as well any opposed state nay the motion unanimously passes on behalf of the committee i direct the staff to finalize a report with the standing committee and video ease deliberation and to compile that report along with the application and all additional material received by the standing committee and to refer to the state board of education for consideration at the next public meeting congratulations

[00:44:32] we will now move to item c which is first review of college partnership laboratory school application from Enry and Henry College. The committee will hear from Dr., excuse me, Mr. Dante Lee, Danny Lee. I'm going to get this one right. My apologies. Mr. Danny Lee and Dr. Lou Fincher from Emory and Henry College, followed by Dr. Armstrong. And we will afford Emory and Henry, just like UVA and Mountain Gateway and our past applicants, an opportunity to also introduce the

[00:45:10] entire team that you have here today. What we typically do is we have our formal presentation first. After your formal presentation, prior to questions from the committee, we'll allow you to encourage you to have all your other interested partners come up to the microphone, state their name, their role in the College Lab application, and any additional comments that they want to share. Then we'll take Q&A. Okay. Thank you very much. And Danny, so I spelled Dante, but the only person call me dante was my father so i knew i was in trouble uh when you said dante

[00:45:51] but uh that's okay thank you uh madam chair again thank you lab school standing committee review members thank you for this opportunity to present today we have a very innovative approach to uh a lab school that we are developing like to take this time to really thank dr armstrong for all of his efforts and working with us he has truly been at our back and tall about any time we have contacted him so uh i don't know what you're paying but we need to increase the pay because he's done an exceptional job with us and i'm sure he has with all other evidence as well the most neat thing about our partnership is um we are the southwest virginia healthcare excellence

[00:46:29] academy lab school we have nine partnering institutions that covers an area of about 90 miles and our partners include smith county public schools uh we have with county public schools we have washington county public schools bristol virginia public schools and our post-secondary institutions include emory and henry college virginia highlands community college and wentville community college two additional partners that we have is the eggland woodhogan governor school and southwest virginia higher education center so when you discuss developing a program like this

[00:47:03] and you have nine partners that covers over 85 miles you uh track a lot of miles a lot of meetings and you have a lot of opportunities to collaborate with some really exciting people that know a lot about education so with this i'll turn it over to dr thinsher she is our senior vice president of emory henry college she is the dean of the health science campus and she is the mastermind behind everything so welcome thank you i want to echo mr lee's comments in terms of thanking

[00:47:39] the planning committee we are honored to be here on your agenda and excited to share with you our land of school program okay okay there you go take it back one okay well and i certainly uh want to echo also mr lee's comments that it has been a phenomenal partnership uh with our

[00:48:19] collaborating partners it's just you can't collaboration doesn't truly capture the meaning of what we've come together and been able to do i would correct mr lee to say i'm not the mastermind of this program but it has been a collaborative effort and actually uh superintendent dennis carter from smith county schools was the brainchild who came to us and said do you want to partner on doing this and it just exploded and grew from there so and you'll have a chance to hear from dennis carter dr carter a little bit later so i have the pleasure of being able to give you the overview of our program and so we're very mission centric very uh mission driven and

[00:48:58] highlighted words that truly capture our program and our intention in terms of again working very collaboratively we have built and will be deploying a very rigorous high quality learning environment

for students who are truly interested in pursuing health care careers we are committed to preparing them to be college ready and career ready in the health care fields and hope to see them move into health care careers and hopefully be in our region doing so and so our vision is very straightforward we want to establish an academic pipeline for for preparing future health

[00:49:35] care professionals who really can meet the health workforce needs in our region and we're very proud of the fact that we this whole program came out of recognizing a need a real shortage for health care providers in southwest virginia and we feel like that this pipeline project allows us to grow our own and to be able to meet that need in terms of putting out future health care professionals that will be serving patients in the future in our region so our overall goal is to increase the

[00:50:11] number of high school graduates that come out of our southwest virginia high schools who particularly will become health care providers and practicing in southwest virginia and we feel like we can meet this goal by developing a sustainable pipeline we use pipeline a lot to be able to talk about our growing our own pipeline to prepare prepare healthcare professionals to meet again the workforce shortages in our area and again to prepare college and career-ready students to pursue the college degrees that would put them onto the pathway of their desired healthcare profession whether that is an associate's degree entry into their career a bachelor's degree entry or does it

[00:50:51] require a graduate degree entry and so we want to be able to provide exploration for them to help them identify that pathway our org chart shows the role of our governing board which i'll show a list of in just a moment uh our we're very pleased with our advisory council that we have seated and i know we have several members of our advisory council i saw them coming on to the screen and joining the zoom meeting we're very happy to have our executive director and assistant director already on board and they have been since summer and then fall mr lee and mr davidson

[00:51:31] We will be hiring a clinical placement coordinator, classroom facilitators. We're already working with a web media manager who developed our online portal application system. And we've also given dedicated time of one of our Emory & Henry administrative staff to provide administrative support.

[00:51:54] And so again, Mr. Lee, our executive director, Mike Davidson, our assistant director, and Karen Alley is an administrative assistant out of my office. and again we will be with approval of funding moving forward to hire a clinical placement coordinator which will be essential because of the experiential opportunities and getting our students into shadowing and into internship opportunities and so our governing board our bylaws state that every one of our nine partners will have a representative on our governing board typically the leader from that institution or organization and emory and henry is the fiscal

[00:52:32] agent for the planning grant has two representatives on our governing board i serve as chair and then dr carter serves as vice chair and our bylaws state that the vice chair will always be one of our peachwell superintendent partners we've already met twice this is a very engaged board it has been from day one and so again it just adds to the collaboration of our team our advisory

[00:53:04] council we intentionally selected the members of our advisory council to meet multiple action items for us either one to be able to help us see gaps in our programming are there areas that we've not thought about pathways we've not thought about but is there curriculum that we've not thought about so we can constantly be looking at continuous improvement we have a number of stakeholders from health care from education from our hospital partners health care partners

[00:53:40] other organizations for example the united way the strong accountable care community and in fact if if they're still on i saw that mark cruise from the strong accountable care community had signed on to zoom and sean mcmurray who is the executive director for wellspring foundation of southwest virginia had signed on and so our our advisory council we've met uh once with this group as i said there were multiple action items that we hoped that this group could help us with one identifying the gaps two being able to help connect us with experiential opportunities getting

[00:54:16] our students into the hospitals the clinics and other health care settings and if the members of the advisory council didn't themselves have a direct access to that for them to connect us with others that could do that and then the third was to connect us with potential funding sources for future funding and of course sustainability and mr davidson will speak to sustainability at the end of our presentation but so this this in and of itself as a group uh when i looked around the room when we met the first time it was really a wow factor to see the number of people that we had at the table and and the institutions and organizations they represented and their genuine

[00:54:54] interest in seeing the HEALS program be successful. So our target student population, and given the guidelines, we would say our program is open to any student in the Commonwealth. However, our targeted population that we will actively recruit are 10th through 12th graders from our partnering institutions, our four school divisions of the I-81 corridor, seeking students who are particularly interested in a health care career and one qualifier being that the applicants must meet their high school's requirements to take dual enrollment courses because our our full curriculum

[00:55:33] involves dual enrollment courses for our admission process we have an online application students apply through that online application we have an admissions committee that review those just to make sure that they have been endorsed by their administration and that they meet the the dual enrollment requirement and then beyond that we have capacity for 50 students out of each cohort if we have applications that exceed 50 then we will go into a lottery system to select students

[00:56:06] for admission students that are admitted they and their parents will attend an orientation session because the parents need to be as engaged and involved in understanding what the students are going to be experiencing throughout their three years in the program and then our direct our assistant director and director have would be meeting regularly with the counselors and the students to build out their course schedule for their 10th 11th and 12th grade year and so it becomes very much engaging in one-on-one interaction with our directors in terms of

[00:56:43] once they're admitted into the program the academic program again is very intended to be very rigorous and includes dual enrollment or concurrent courses and the coursework is specifically geared towards either a specific healthcare pathway which we'll look at in a moment but also the the foundational science courses that are required for all healthcare professions giving them those at the dual enrollment level building that skill set and that knowledge base before they move into their college degree whether it be associate's degree bachelor's degree or

[00:57:20] graduate degree and so we have the foundational sciences we have introductory health care content including introductory health care skills we have ability to provide health care career exploration through career forums through the shadowing opportunities and then experiential health care career-based opportunities again through the shadowing and through the internship opportunities so the

pathways that i mentioned right now we had we started with six these could grow these could shrink based upon what we see in terms of interest of our students and also

[00:57:57] the the ongoing needs in our community for healthcare professionals we split allied health into two categories because they are so broad allied health diagnostic which tends to be more of the technology level radiology tech ultrasound tech allied health physical rehabilitation which includes physical therapy, occupational therapy, speech path, athletic trainer, that type of profession. Medicine, which includes not only the physicians, but also the physician assistant, and the dental. We have several students who are actually interested in either dentistry or

[00:58:35] orthodontist, orthodontistry. Mental behavioral health. We know that there is a dire need for mental health care professionals in our region, actually across the country. And so that pathway is very important to the program and would lead to a number of the types of careers in mental health whether it be a social work mental health counseling substance abuse counseling that type of thing nursing we want to be able to show students the broad range of career paths within nursing everything from the entry point of rn up through the bs trained nurse all the way up through

[00:59:12] the advanced practice nurse in terms of nurse practitioner and so we want to be able to show the the pathways of what students could be able to possibly achieve and then pharmacy we actually have a student or two that is interested in a pharmacy pathway which includes pharmacy and pharmacy tech and so our program the the fifth grade year the idea is that all students would take the same coursework and it's a cohort based program so the 10th grade gives the foundation for them to begin to then explore what specific pathway they might want to move on to and so

[00:59:51] those introductory courses of orientation to health related professions ethics for healthcare personnel and medical terminology those three are the key foundational 10th grade courses and then other courses that might be added in developmental psychology is a prereq for almost every healthcare profession. Chemistry, which could replace their high school chemistry, would be a foundational course that would be required for almost all health profession programs.

[01:00:18] As they move into their junior year, through their exploration, they will start to look at what specific pathway or pathways do they want to be studying through. Almost all of them require anatomy and physiology. Again, these are dual credit courses. We are having created a Spanish for healthcare professionals which is a key course i think for our students to really be able to have healthcare specific language skills in spanish language and then the other courses can be from electives everything from the maths that they would need going into a healthcare

[01:00:56] degree to psychology or other health healthcare electives based upon the pathway and then their senior year which they really should be very focused in on not only do they know which career path they want to be on but they know where they are looking at going to school and so again getting more of the foundational sciences that will position them to be successful in their health care career career degree and then adding in other advanced topics as well and so all three of the years 10th 11th and 12th also include the experiential learning component and again those

[01:01:33] are dual enrollment as well and so the 10th grade year would be an introductory topics for health care we will be taking the students out into hospital settings and they can be able to explore a variety of roles within the hospital setting 11th grade year topics in health care they begin to narrow in their focus and then 12th grade with an internship they begin to really be in the field that they're looking

at pursuing we have two main instructional sites our southwest virginia higher education center on our southern end and then our emory and henry health science campus on our

[01:02:11] northern end our four school divisions we've divided into cohorts so the bristol virginia cohort and washington county cohort most of the time would be transported into the higher ed center because that's close proximity for them whereas the smith and with county cohorts which are further north would be transported into our hill science campus in marion there will be opportunities for students to cross-populate across the two campuses because there are health care programs

[01:02:44] in graduate students and undergraduate health care students on both campuses that are of different disciplines that allow the students to be able to have that connection with those peers and some mentorship from those peers our partners in the public school divisions through their collaboration in-kind funding will provide the transportation for the students to be able to go to the sites the typical academic schedule ours is a half-day program we want our students to still be able to

[01:03:18] compete to participate in their athletics band fine arts other activities they have on campus so our schedule will be in the morning they will be transported to one of those two campuses and then they will travel back to their home school for the afternoon student support services also provided collaboratively so in the way of career counseling and mentoring services not only do we have the high school counselors we have our directors that work very closely with the students and then we want to bring in those health care graduate and undergraduate

[01:03:56] students to specifically be able to speak about the life the day in the life of a health care student in in college and what their career aspirations are student disabilities they will be identified at public school level of course the higher ed partners will assist them in providing those accommodations transportation provided by our public school divisions and in the most recent meeting of our partners talking about some of the internship opportunities there may be the need for the heels program to provide some transportation to some of the internship sites particularly when we start to have individualized

[01:04:32] internship assignments. And so from an enrollment standpoint, again, I mentioned earlier, we have capacity for 50 students in a cohort. A lot of that capacity is designed because we want to make sure we have those experiential opportunities, the shadowing and the internship opportunities. If we find that we are blessed to have plentiful sites for students to go to, we would want to increase that student enrollment capacity. And so in year one of

[01:05:02] 24-25 academic year we would have 100 students enrolled 50 sophomores and 50 juniors and then we will grow in year two to be at 150 and then we would be graduating if you look at we would graduate our first cohort at the end of the 25-26 academic year and then cohorts of 50 thereafter

[01:05:33] And from the budget standpoint, I know this is in the application, but just to hide the 30,000-foot view, the one-time startup funding, the capital funding really is designed, one, to provide, purchase and install video conferencing equipment that will actually allow our two campuses to connect.

[01:05:54] And that way, if we do have a speaker or an instructor on one campus and we really want both campuses to be able to hear that, they can be able to connect in that way. Also, adding equipment, multi-task trainers to be able to teach clinical skills and equipment in our simulation labs on both campuses, which also provide those experiential learning opportunities.

[01:06:18] Personnel expenses that are outlined in the application, the dual enrollment and concurrent expenses with our community college partners, our general operating expenses, uh administrative fee we built in just because of the the administrative duties uh they go along with being the fiscal agent on emory and henry park um and our little boxes covering it up but with with startup and our operational expenses we had originally proposed for 6.7 million this just

[01:06:54] breaks it down over the five-year period to be able to see the accumulation uh and growth in the budget and then what we wanted to really point out here is if you look at the video guidelines for per pupil funding rates which is 9 578 we actually in looking at our projected budget and our projected enrollment are actually below that that in the first year 9 501 but then decreasing from there that we would be operating at less than what the video guideline for people

[01:07:30] funding cost is is allocated and so with that i want to turn it over to mike davidson to speak uh in regards to our sustainability i am mike davidson i'm the assistant director of the hills program and obviously as the assistant director logan on the turtle bowl sustainability falls in my lap so as we know it's probably the most challenging aspect of the uh of the program and right now when i speak of sustainability the first thing i have to really mention is

[01:08:07] the um what's already been promised and given to us in in-kind donations um the two facilities that we'll be using this campuses um they've already provided us with all the space and classroom space that will be available when you're adding the support services to go along with that we have over 200 000 worth of donations of income just in that area then when we throw in our lab spaces the simulation labs the lab spaces the study spaces the other spaces that our students we'll be able to access we can't even put a dollar amount on what all that will be including the equipment that parts do will be used and so there's a tremendous amount of sustainability

[01:08:46] that's provided in any kind of donations and then when we look at our public school partners they have pledged transportation and all kinds of other things that they're willing to do to make this a sustainable program when we look at our partnership the the thing that has been mentioned before is the number of partners that we have and all of those partners have said we're going to make this work and when we go to our governing board we've got the leaderships of all the educational partners then we look at the advisory council though that council is made up of leaders in the

[01:09:21] healthcare field where there's pledging support whether it's going to be facilities or it's going to be people to help our students learn from but then we also have philanthropy groups that are there whether it's a direct connection or an indirect connection to those groups that are going to uh or that have said that they will support our program as far as sustainability we do not have a direct amount that we can put down on paper and say this is what people are going to do we feel that we need to get our program up and running once we are up and running and we have that success of our students we know that that support is going to continue to grow

[01:10:00] but we do we've already had conversations with groups such as the um claude moore foundation we've had conversations with well springs foundation we have had a ballot help is is certainly been involved in our conversations they are actually starting a the ballot academy in east tennessee um which is going to be similar to what we're doing they're a little behind us they're starting later but but their program and our program we've already had conversations there the gatton foundation we have

connections we have um smith the smith educational foundation the planned with planned foundation so we have a number of places where we've had conversations

[01:10:40] we do not have had no plans to wait until year four or five and say wait a minute we have to have help we're starting out early but as far as anything we put down on paper we have not developed an ask yet we don't feel that it's appropriate to develop and ask until we officially are of action but we do feel confident we have partners that are willing to step up and this is the point where we want to have our partners that are here um you you want everyone to come up is that what you like they made the journey absolutely so if they will come up um first we'd like to

[01:11:15] thank you for hearing our presentation but if our partners we have um so for each of your partners that are here if they can state their name their role in the area and a contribution that they have specific to the lab application and if they have any remarks that they'd like to share with the standing committee we would love to hear those as well just as we heard from our gracious host from uva i'll start i'm like i'm going to have you come to the microphone though because i do want to come on down gentlemen i do want to ensure that it's uh audible for the rest of the folks listening

[01:11:53] remotely and we have it on the record thank you i'm mike robinson i'm with the ableton governor school and um as a partner in this project our school in particular human anatomy and physiology class was a destination for a lot of students that were interested in the medical field we could not expand to do all of these types of things in our current environment so when dennis approached me with the idea of doing this i'm like i'm 100 on board because this is where we want to be the space there's we know that there's interest in that program and in that field in our area and a huge need and so we're very excited to be delivering some of the content for them and

[01:12:30] with them in this program all right a little tight space in the front here well good evening my name is david batlock i'm the agency head and executive director of the southwest virginia higher education center and on behalf of my board chairman uh senator todd pillia and my board and my college partners we're very excited to be a part of this process at the southwest virginia education center we have 11 college universities provide content and programs of study in our building many of which fit like a glove with this program when we were approached uh um and henry we started planning

[01:13:08] this vcu we have a doctoral program in nurse anesthesia and the vcu bachelor degrees are residential programs in clinical lab science we also have a doctoral program in pharmacy with the Appalachian College of Pharmacy, Nurse Practitioner Program, and the RN, the BSN program with Keene Universities as well as Radford University when it comes to the counseling and substance abuse.

[01:13:31] So our partners got very excited and they all want to know what can we do to make this happen because we see ourselves at the Southwest Virginia Education Center as an important piece of this pathway. So we've already pledged $100,000 initially in any kind support and we stand ready on behalf of my board I can say boldly today we stand ready to do whatever's necessary to help these students enter into this program and provide pathway opportunities so we're excited and we're

[01:13:59] thankful for the opportunity we have to come here today greetings greetings my name is Dennis Carter I'm superintendent of Smith County thank you for the opportunity to be here today need drives innovation and this is certainly a need in southwest Virginia across the commonwealth for medical providers and one of the things that drives us most is having our students grow and stay in our community.

[01:14:32] And we see this as economic development opportunity. But more importantly, we see this as making our community stronger. We have lots of our students who have the opportunity for growth but may not see the potential within themselves. So having this experiential learning opens up doors for those students and certainly provides meets a need for our community with the behavioral health and the medical side.

[01:14:54] In our area, behavioral health is a major problem, that drives a lot of our synergy and energy and meeting this goal and we can have a youngster in crisis that we can get pretty much immediate help for but if we have a youngster that may be on the verge of crisis it may be two to three weeks out before they can see a provider so we do have a dream to have integrated health care within southwest virginia where a youngster could have a medical service and if they see some type of behavioral health concern have a soft hand-off to a mental health provider within the same facility but to be able to do that we require staffing and we just do not have the staffing so again he drives innovation and the synergy and the collaboration

[01:15:32] with all the partners that we have is just it's amazing it's truly heartwarming and and something to be proud of in southwest virginia and again thank you for the opportunity for us to be here thank you for being here morning i'm david scott superintendent bristol virginia public schools thank you to the standing committee and thank you to everybody from bdoe and emery and henry it's been an honor to help with this project and to be a collaborator with such outstanding

[01:16:09] thinkers as we think about how to serve our community for me it's i'm a firm believer in educational outcomes shouldn't be based on your zip code and so when we have people in far southwest virginia to be able to expand the the area from which they can work with experts experts and um increase that experiential learning opportunities i think that's that's a no-brainer for us in bristol make sure that we're engaging our students early in this process and to give them opportunities that they you know it might not be completely obvious to them that those opportunities are out there so it's been a pleasure to work with these gentlemen and women

[01:16:48] from that standpoint thank you thank you we also have two of our part of academic partners on zoom excellent um let's see um where's our i.t supports i think um can we get the screen for our two guests so for our two additional zoom guests from emory and henry so we have two of our board of members of our governing board and then three of our advisory council we're going to see

[01:17:23] if we can get everyone up on screen and if not i'm going to come back to you once it rejoins us in the room so if we can't do it now no pressure for those of you listening in um that are part of this application and team we will find a way to make sure you get an opportunity to visually share and be part of the conversation and i think they just start speaking they'll be okay so adam you you want to introduce yourself? Can you go to a different screen to do, yeah, do the one that

[01:17:58] looks like nine dots. Yeah, there we go. Well, hello. Excellent. So, Adam, you want to go first?

[01:18:13] Sure. Good morning, everyone. I'm Adam Hutchison. I'm the president at Virginia Highlands Community College. I'm sorry I couldn't be with you this morning, but I appreciate the travel plans that my colleagues have made, especially our school superintendents who have so much on their plates. I'm grateful for the partnership with Emory & Henry for more than 50 years.

[01:18:31] Virginia Highlands has kind of sat on the far southwest edge of the service area there. We serve Washington County and the western portion of Smith County and the city of Bristol. And we share the excitement for this opportunity to serve these students in a unique way as a lab school. The Southwest Virginia Higher Education Center is immediately adjacent to Virginia Highlands Community College.

[01:18:52] And so I'd like to consider us as one large campus that serves our region. And we fully support the project as is presented to you today. We look forward to providing dual enrollment and considerable pathways for these students to engage at the community college level, finishing certificates and degrees on their way to great careers here in Southwest Virginia in all sectors of the health care occupations, both mental health and, as was described, the diagnostic and the rehabilitative supports for allied health.

[01:19:21] Thank you. Dr. Poole? Mr. Poole, we're unable to hear you. We can see you.

[01:19:36] I feel like I'm on a Zoom, right? That happens how many times a day? We're going to make sure we can hear you. We're going to come back to you, Mr. Poole, in just a moment. Dr. Fincher, who would you like to go to next? So we have members from our advisory council. So Sean McMurray on the bottom left square.

[01:19:55] Mr. Poole, we're going to give you some time to sort out the microphone or your sound. We'll come back to you, though, sir. Hello, I'm Sean McMurray. I'm the executive director at the Wellspring Foundation of Southwest Virginia. And our mission is to enhance the health and well-being of the people who live in four Virginia counties in our area, including the counties covered by this particular initiative.

[01:20:21] And we're just happy to be at the table and feel like some great things are ahead. One of the areas of interest that we have is health care workforce development, and we think this lines up well with our interests.

[01:20:37] So we're pleased to support this effort. Thank you. Tricia Van Hoy. Hello. I'm Tricia Van Hoy. I'm the Senior Nurse Manager for the Mount Rogers Health District.

[01:20:55] We are very excited about this project. We cover eight localities across far southwest Virginia, and including the service areas that were mentioned in this project. I think this is really a very unique and special initiative.

[01:21:17] I know we struggle with getting our health care providers finding applicants in the last few years. It's been much more of a struggle for us. So we are just very excited to be a part of this.

[01:21:33] And, you know, we look forward to seeing what this will do. And we do support it wholeheartedly. Thank you. Mark Cruz. Good morning, I'm Mark Cruz. I'm the director of the Strong Accountable Care Community.

[01:21:52] STRONG stands for Striving Towards Resilience and Opportunity for the Next Generation. We're a bi-state coalition of 400 organizations in Southwest Virginia and Northeast Tennessee working together to improve physical, social, and economic health.

[01:22:08] We do this through focusing on early childhood development, youth success, and workforce development, leading to economic mobility by age 25. And so we're super excited about the Healthcare Excellence Academy Lab School and the potential it has to address some of the substantial healthcare professional shortages in the region, in particular the four.

[01:22:44] - Mr. Cruz, you've frozen on our screen. We'll see if he comes back and if he does, we'll certainly allow him a chance to complete his remarks. And Mr. Poole, are we having any better luck with you for uh audio oh not quite yet um sir would you uh we can provide you with a staff phone number and we can maybe get you to call in that way are we allowed to do that i just want to make sure that he has an opportunity since he's he can also place his comment in the chat oh mr pool would you

[01:23:19] like to uh place your remarks otherwise into the chat i know that that's really not the same i want to acknowledge that and like 150 characters oh there we go excellent you've solved all my dilemmas for me thank you we were trying to problem solve this one all right so you can't hear it now correct are you there yes please proceed okay uh wesley pool superintendent with county public schools just want to thank you for this opportunity we're very excited about having the opportunity to collaborate with all the wonderful organizations that are represented.

[01:24:00] As a region, we are very excited about the opportunities that this will provide our students, especially in filling a very large need for us here in southwest Virginia. So not to be long-winded, just want to agree with all of my peers and say what a wonderful opportunity this is.

[01:24:20] thank you mr pool and for your persistence thank you for making sure you could share those remarks with us thank you very much and mr cruz i'm sorry the technology wasn't interrupted your remarks would you like to continue sir i'm not sure where i went out i do apologize for the the glitch but the strong accountable care community is really excited for the heels project we uh we we are working hard in our region to address the health professional shortages that exist throughout the region including in the four jurisdictions that are noted in the project and we think this is a

[01:24:58] great counterbalance to the health the ballot health academy project on the tennessee side of our footprint we think there's a lot of opportunity for synergy sharing notes and and successes as well as how to overcome challenges between the two projects so we're really excited and happy to support this effort in any way that we can madam chair i saw one more person sign in although I don't see him on the screen. Dr. Michael Puglisi, is he still with us? So Dr. Puglisi is our

[01:25:32] executive vice president and provost at Emory & Henry College. Welcome, sir. Thank you. I will just add my endorsement to those of the other partners who have spoken. The need for health care professionals in the region is definitely evident. And we believe that this lab school, the Heals Lab School provides an avenue for growing our own in the region and keeping them here in the region to fulfill the health care needs that we have. Emery and Henry is certainly

[01:26:05] a dedicated participant in this project, along with the other partners, and we feel strongly that this is a project that serves the region. Thank you. You know, on behalf of the committee, I want to first say that we really do value and appreciate both the time for you to travel today, to share your remarks, as well as the individuals who have participated remotely.

[01:26:34] We really listen and we appreciate that engagement. And it shows. When we meet with applicants, we can, you know, authentic partnership is what we're looking for. Authentic and deep, sustainable partnership.

[01:26:50] And so I want you to know that we take very seriously and very much appreciate the time that you've invested to be here and to contribute to this conversation. Even if you spoke briefly, know that it carries weight with the committee and it is much appreciated, so thank you. At this time, before I do

questions, I'm actually gonna go to Dr. Armstrong for him to present a staff report, and then we'll do questions.

[01:27:13] Some of the questions the committee may have is actually gonna need the assistance of Dr. Armstrong. So I wanna kind of tee up both of you at the same time, and then we can ask unified questions. - Thank you, Madam Chair, thank you to the Emory & Henry Southwest Virginia Heals team. Committee members, I'd like to provide a brief overview on behalf of the agency on the Emory & Henry College Southwest Virginia Healthcare Excellence Academy, Southwest Virginia Heals Lab School application. Southwest Virginia Heals will provide a comprehensive healthcare-focused career academy, which includes extensive dual enrollment coursework, hands-on learning experiences, and pathways to in-demand regionally responsive healthcare career credentials. Emory & Henry College and their

[01:27:52] partners, Virginia Highlands Community College, the Southwest Virginia Higher Education Center, A. Lynn Whitholton Governor's School, and the Public School Divisions of Smith with Washington County and the City of Bristol have presented a quality proposal that represents significant support and cooperation from among higher education and casewell public education in Southwest Virginia, an area of the Commonwealth that features healthcare and health sciences as a major area of workforce demand. Our review of the Southwest Virginia HEALS application has included multiple rounds of subject matter expert feedback and several calls before and since the submission of the application in December of 2023. The Southwest Virginia HEALS team has been

[01:28:31] responsive and inquisitive as they have thoughtfully adjusted their plan to meet the compliance request requirements and questions that we've had around Virginia lab schools. As you'll see in the attached completeness and compliance report for the purposes of first standing committee review TODAY. THE EMERING HENRY SOUTHWEST VIRGINIA HEALS APPLICATION IS READY TO IMPLEMENT IN THE ELEMENTS OF EXECUTIVE SUMMARY, EDUCATIONAL PROGRAM, GOVERNANCE, FINANCIAL AND OPERATIONAL INFORMATION, PLACEMENT PLAN, AND OTHER ASSURANCES AND REQUIREMENTS. UNDER MISSION AND VISION, WE WOULD LIKE TO CLARIFY THE PATHWAY TO ALL OF THE SOQ MANDATED GRADUATION REQUIREMENTS AND ENSURE THAT ANY SUMMER LEARNING, IF REQUIRED, IS ACCESSIBLE AND INCLUDES DETAILED INFORMATION

[01:29:10] on transportation and related operational needs to ensure accessibility to students. Under Management Structure, we would like to ensure that the Southwest Virginia Heals proposal meets the statutory requirement that the lab school is "open to any student in the Commonwealth." While Southwest Virginia Heals has provided additional detail related to the administration of the lottery, we want to ensure that any prerequisite or enrollment requirements are not prohibited to enrollment that the application reflects that as well.

[01:29:38] Also under management structure, VDOE, as we mentioned before, with another applicant, is currently developing some best practice for all lab schools to meet the statutory requirement that lab school teachers are employed by the higher education partner but have or are eligible to have a valid K-12 Virginia teacher license. Emory & Henry, unlike other lab school applicants, is employing dedicated higher ed faculty to teach the dual enrollment coursework, and while this is commonly acceptable throughout dual enrollment programs all across the Commonwealth, the lab school statute as referenced before is more specific in its requirement that a lab school teacher be employed by the higher ed institute and hold a valid k-12 virginia teacher license

[01:30:17] the administrative code and its definitions of virginia teacher licenses does include a dual enrollment or ct license that would appear to satisfy this statutory requirement on behalf of emory and henry and any lab school with a similar model and we anticipate being able to work with emory and henry prior to second review to resolve that with more formalized notice finally under Under management structure, we would like to refine the language of the Student Code of Conduct.

[01:30:40] There's a Student Code of Conduct Clause 16, which requires that students maintain appropriate boundaries in their relationships with the Emory & Henry students they will encounter. It's imperative to avoid situations that could be misconstrued or deemed inappropriate. We simply wish to ensure that the Southwest Virginia Heals proposal outlines steps that will be taken to proactively ensure that any interaction with Emory & Henry students or staff are appropriate and that there is reciprocal accountability for those post-secondary students taking part for maintaining appropriate relationships with students which will like to be accomplished by referencing your existing codes of conduct as referencing the

[01:31:16] overview a document included in your Virginia agenda Emory and Henry as our first private school higher education partner qualifies as a private institution of higher education in Virginia and is eligible to participate in the college partnership laboratory school program by the definition of college partnership laboratory school found in the statute 22.1349.1 which defines this as a public non-sectarian non-religious school in the commonwealth established by a public institution of higher education public higher education center institute or authority or an eligible institution as defined in 231-628 a public higher education

[01:31:54] institution of higher education a public higher education center institute or authority or an eligible institution as defined in 231628, which may submit an application for formation of a college partnership laboratory school. And the important part here is that 231628 defines an eligible institution as a non-profit private institution of higher education whose primary purpose is to provide collegiate graduate or professional education and not to provide religious training or theological education. And at this point, I stand prepared to answer any further questions on behalf of the agency. Thank you, Dr. Armstrong. On behalf of the

[01:32:31] committee, I'll begin with a couple questions for the applicant after consultation with some of our members. There's a couple areas that have surfaced through both the VDOE review as well as from our deliberation where we would appreciate some further consideration and dialogue. The first is on the area of access to all students so i um one of the gating criteria in your application is that students must be uh participating in the dual enrollment program and it is our understanding

[01:33:07] and dr armstrong is going to correct me if we have this incorrect it's our understanding that the statute makes very clear that lab schools need to be open to all students and when we've met with other interested applicants this is really a point that the committee has underscored that the school needs to be open to all students and open if necessary by lottery could you address if you would be able to adjust your program of study to ensure access for all students and just kind of talk us through uh your consideration of admission you want us to go up there or yes

[01:33:45] please i believe that we have a just to make sure for a microphone and then that way you're on camera i think that that'll just make sure we have the audio recording thank you and thank you for that question that is something that we as a governing board all of our partners have continued to discuss one

of the aspects that i'll come at it from two different directions and i'll also want mr lee to address it as well virginia has a very robust cte program throughout our school divisions and so when we looked at the population that we really wanted to attract to meet the

[01:34:24] healthcare professional fields that we were looking at we really felt like those advanced courses the foundation sciences were going to be key for the success of those students we also wanted to make sure that we did not in any way adversely affect the cte programs and so i feel like and we've even met with all of the cte directors in our school divisions to talk about how there may be opportunities where they may have a CTE student who actually could benefit from coming to some of the coursework or her career forums or other activities within the lab school

[01:35:00] we may find that we have students who don't do well academically as some of the foundational sciences but they see a pathway through a CTE program and so I do see that we would have some movement back and forth with that when looking at building the curriculum again wanting it to be the courses that would be prerequisites for college degrees in the health professions and or prerequisites that the students would have to take as part of their college degrees that the rigor of those courses does expect students to be able to meet that rigor and so because they're dual enrollment we had to turn to our k-12 partners to say

[01:35:40] what are your expectations or requirements for your students to be able to take dual enrollment courses and so that's why that was set as a entry point if they don't need that we would put them on a wait list and then be able to look at them in the future for bringing them in at a later point in time but we don't want to bring a student in that would then not be able to be successful in the program i mean we are going to be very alert to the students throughout the curriculum to find students immediately when they start to have difficulty academically but we just don't want

[01:36:14] to push student into the program that would would really really struggle uh in that academic program you want to add to that i'm sure can i interject please dr armstrong and this is uh as we know this has not been a a unique conversation we've had with any lab school applicants i think in our work continuing with the emory henry team between now and if considered for a second review or even further um is to really work with emory henry to revise their applications and maybe think about this inside out so instead of making the dual enrollment qualification criteria to be

[01:36:50] considered because that would not be in alignment with the statute that's just here we have to we have to meet that sexual requirement and maybe it's simply thinking of a way that if a student who is admitted through this open process to be part of this and then at that point shows that perhaps they may need some work getting to the point where they're eligible maybe part of this is going to be building that student up at that point it's just a matter i think of taking this and thinking about in a different way um this is a common statutory pothole that we've been navigating i see susan williams smiling as well we've discussed this with many of our applicants so um we'll we'll continue to work in routine between now and our next step yeah this so that you know

[01:37:30] this is a it is a pothole or a bump that we've had with other applicants and the committee has taken a very strong and consistent view with the statute that all means all open means open and we really are of the belief that the differentiation that can occur in lab schools is the ability to push in and provide additional support so that any student really could access the curriculum and so i think that's something

we can you can probably confidently work with the bdoe on but it will require some modification to the application and further review and i dr moran

[01:38:10] would you like to comment on this item or have some feedback on it well i i think that you know and I always sometimes put on my former superintendent hat 'cause I realized that both school divisions as well as community colleges can set up barrier requirements for students to enter into coursework, whether it's on site, whether it's dual enrollment on a school campus or not.

[01:38:35] But I do think that the biggest issue in this situation is that the way the statute's written, it really does tie our hands to be able to say, what can we do to do open enrollment but then if we have students that are students that that would likely not achieve success because of of academic issues how is it that we can scaffold some support for those students to be able to participate because i think everybody in this room everybody superintendents teachers educators parents community members us what we want is for

[01:39:14] every student to thrive and be successful in these programs and not to have it set up as a failure for them right from the start so i think that's probably the the biggest uh hurdle that you have to overcome is how do you build a scaffolding mechanism into the proposal i think that one of the things that we have considered is building an on-ramp and off-ramp for this for student entry or student exit uh it is a rigorous program i certainly want people in health care to to take the courses seriously and their job seriously so uh we want to give students every student that has an interest in the program opportunity and it may be through some of our career forums maybe through

[01:39:54] some of our shadowing opportunities just exposure so those are opportunities that we we think that we can provide for each of the student that has an interest in the program and that might be that we add additional uh in our pathways to be able to look at coursework that would that would be appropriate and i do think that would then communicate back or collaborate back with the cte programs and so it's probably building a connection i would love to comment on that because one of the pieces that i saw missing in the pathways were those entry-level areas

[01:40:30] of focus whether it's a certified nursing assistant perhaps an emt or a paramedic those kinds of programs that give kids that maybe are looking for a way to level up at some point a starting place and I did notice that when I was looking at this proposal over the weekend I did a little research and saw that 93 percent of the health care facilities particularly nursing homes really are showing deficits in terms of certified nursing assistants for example

[01:41:04] which is a very different pathway than going towards an REM level and we were intentional and actually that was conversations we had with our partners from the very beginning because the CTE programs particularly in nursing and EMT are so strong there was feedback from our partners that they don't want those programs to be hurt in any way by the development of the HEALS program and so we didn't want to cannibalize or pull students away from those because they are being so successful so i think we can look at better ways to partner so that when we have

[01:41:41] students that might need to bridge both then we can provide that opportunity but that's why we didn't include the career pathway of say the lpn or certified nurse assistant or beginning emt is because those are so well developed already through the school division cte program and you did mention that in your presentation that bridging opportunity thank you dr brand i have a couple other kind of committee-

wide comments but did you want to go through any questions that you specifically have first and that was a big one i know that we have all as committee members kind

[01:42:17] of voice but i want to the other area that um if you're on good i'm on i think the other area that we consistently talk about with folks is that sustainability piece and really focusing on and we got a a broad brush of all of the potential ways that that you would be able to bring additional resources into this um and i appreciated that but i do think that there probably needs to be in a next review more specificity about how that might work particularly with foundations

[01:42:55] i'll add um on behalf of some of the conversations i too have had with committee members uh it has been really reinforced the intention these are startup funds investment funds right and the goal is durable sustainable and this is it is a challenge for applicants and it is something that we have heartily dialogued with other interested parties with and absolutely mr davidson appreciate your candor i mean it is a struggle that we have heard from other applicants as they're

[01:43:34] trying to think through how will they sustain the work why that becomes so incredibly important particularly for a program such as this is your people are your program your staffing will be year program and so we want to ensure that if students enroll in year five that there's a year six years so i i think that'll definitely be an area for you for the applicant to further workshop and i know you have some of your foundation members on the phone and maybe this additional

[01:44:10] push will help but we we really do have to have something more concrete uh because we need to know that if students enroll that this path is going to be able for them to complete the process too so those are those are two very big areas um i do i've heard from other committee members they're very excited about your application i do want you to know that they are very excited they're very excited about they understand the need for what you're proposing pick up the news every day you see the the shortage in the health care fields we understand from the data that you

[01:44:49] provide and from our own knowledge of virginia the unique geographical challenge that you have as an applicant um but you know and we're very we are very excited about those components of it here's what i would suggest at this point just because i think these are two really big questions is that we are going to without if there's no objection um the committee's going to refer you back to videoe for further technical support and guidance and we would do so in the area number one of ensuring that you have access for all students including utilizing the current guidance on the

[01:45:28] lottery number two that there's further information on sustainability a concrete plan for how you will sustain this effort uh three i'll roll into this we heard based on the staff report uh further clarification on your summer program to ensure its accessibility and then four uh as dr armstrong surfaced uh again the modification the clarification around the student code of conduct if there's anything that we've missed in this deliberation certainly we'll want you to have a chance to

[01:46:02] address it with staff through that dialogue those those first two in particular the statute's very clear and we have to abide by so are there any questions or clarification at this point on that direction that you or any guidance that you might need from the committee i want to make sure that you have the information and i know dr armstrong will be available to you and once in terms of process here's how it would work you'll work with the staff you'll have time as a team to deliberate

[01:46:36] based on the feedback that you've heard today think about your academic program and you can submit a revised application and we will take that application and work with dr armstrong and schedule you again but but those areas would need to be addressed and we'll need more information i think would that have us coming back as a second review or would that be considered another first that would still be your first review yep that would still be your first review at this juncture you've not cleared yet first review yeah yeah those those are key components for an application to clear that's a great clarifying question and another question we frequently will get from

[01:47:13] applicants is if i'll uh for example um we sometimes have applicants who get feedback when do i have to show up again am i on a shot clock do i have to be back in 30 days we want to We want to ensure that you are successful. If you need, you take as much time as you choose, but understand that we do also have a process and a timeline by which we need to move through applications given funding obligation requirements.

[01:47:42] But, and Dr. Armstrong can further inform you on that, but I do want you to know that you'll probably need to move with some degree due speed. We also want you to have the opportunity to deliberate, as we've said to other applicants through the process.

[01:47:59] Quality is the focus that may not always mean expediency, but quality is the focus and durability and sustainability. So absolutely. And I would say that that one of the reasons why I signed on to be a part of the standing committee is that too often.

[01:48:17] I think that what we we have as a process that exists when these kinds of funds are available, where you hit a gate, and it's either yes or no, and that what we've really tried to build the end of this process through chairwoman would discuss leadership is the opportunity for our applicants to go to be able to do some revisions and come right back to us and uh andy will be working with us because we do want to be as expeditious as possible in that turnaround so take your time

[01:48:52] but don't take too much time is what i would advise because we do have timelines we have to make so but i i also i'm thrilled i'm thrilled not just with your proposal but listening to the other two today and the ones that we've seen before this that the diversity of innovation that is very specifically going after local and regional community needs through these proposals and the partnerships that are being built. I think it's exactly what we would say is the best work that

[01:49:29] we could do as public educators is to build those kinds of relationships. Yeah, we love to hear, hey, I had an idea. I called the superintendent or the superintendent called me and we realized here's an opportunity for us to collaborate together. That's been one of the most powerful elements of this is an opportunity for K-12 to intentionally work with higher ed and blend that experience and create new on ramps for students. So we're very thrilled about that. So thank you

[01:50:05] for coming before the committee and continue to work with Dr. Armstrong. Thank you. Okay. Thank you look forward to seeing okay at this time we are going to proceed with item d i know that we've been going for a little bit i might entertain a 10-minute break i'm good okay i'm going to entertain a 10-minute break okay and then we'll come back and we'll regroup and we'll begin with

[01:50:37] Item B. Thank you very much.

[02:00:01] everybody runs a better meeting when there's food available nobody wants a case of the hangry

[02:00:40] all right well we have reconvened after our brief recess we're now going to take up item d which is a lab school update dr armstrong and i will co-present this item we understand that there are a number of questions regarding lab school applications both from applicants as well as the public and other interested parties and the purpose of item d today as i indicated in my opening remarks is to provide an overview

[02:01:14] of our process so here we go perfect here we go is the purpose of our presentation today is to provide information on the house and senate budget measures to review the school lab process for consideration including terminology that is used behind the scenes for lab school applications we'll also provide information on the approved public lab schools including data on number of students served school divisions involved and communities served by these programs and lastly we will provide information on all school lab applications that are currently under review by

[02:01:51] vdoe as part of our usual pipeline update so the next in recent weeks there's been legislative activity in both the house and the senate as it relates to college lab schools here on the slide you can see the language that was approved on the House floor as well as the language that was approved on the Senate floor. If we go to the next slide, here is the process to review a college

[02:02:26] partnership laboratory committee application. In particular, I want to dial in on where the committee falls in this process and where VDOE falls. As you can see across the green band at the very top. This is the first really step in the process to submit a college lab application.

[02:02:50] This is when the Institute of Higher Education, as noted in the small yellow boxes, submits its application. Once the application is "submitted," which is a term of art we use internally in our process, it now begins the under review process with the Virginia Department of Education. We're We're going to go into that in just a little bit greater detail.

[02:03:16] Once it clears the review process, which can be iterative and involve technical support visits, on-site coaching or counseling on the application, and there's a back and forth iteration, once an application is found to be complete and compliant, as the chair of the committee, I'm contacted by VDOE, and at that time, we schedule the first consideration of the application.

[02:03:42] At this juncture, a college partnership lab committee application is considered pending. Once an application has gone through first and second review of the committee, including a 10-day public comment period, which effectively affords three opportunities for public comment at our first review, 10-day public comment period, and a second review, once it has completed this entire process, if an application earns the support of the entire committee, then the

[02:04:20] application is forwarded to the State Board of Education. At this time, the application is considered to be before the State Board of Education. An application is only considered to be approved once it has cleared this entire process and has been voted on by the State Board of Education, either on first and second review.

[02:04:46] And this is particularly important if you go to the next slide. Oh, I'm going to actually have you jump one more. Thank you. So a couple terms of art that we use through our process that we want to share with the applicants as well as interested parties.

[02:05:02] You'll see that when an application is first submitted and it begins the review process, we consider it to be under review. When it has completed that internal subject matter review process, it is

deemed complete and compliant. When it comes before this lab committee, as considered today, for example, for Mountain Gateway or UVA, then it is considered pending. It is only considered an approved application once it has gone through this entire process, including receiving an affirmative vote from

[02:05:38] the State Board of Education. Okay, that's just a terminology that we use, and sometimes when individuals ask questions, they might combine a pending application into an under-review application category or an approved application category, so we just want to really clarify where an application is in the process. And we want to talk a little bit about the subject matter review team. We heard a little bit about this already from Dr. Armstrong. When the standing

[02:06:11] committee created this process it was very important to the standing committee in recognition of the numerous state laws and areas of policy and legal expertise that is required to operate a public school in the commonwealth of virginia that the college lab applications would be reviewed by a team of subject matter experts at videoe with a deep subject matter knowledge in the area for example the video we process you've heard from dr armstrong is incredibly thorough

[02:06:47] and the committee itself internally is comprised of experts at the department of education who are familiar with budget and finance teaching and learning special populations which may include special education or ell gifted or bilingual who have a deep subject matter expertise and and familiarity with the legal requirements, such as assessment and accountability and teacher education and licensure requirements.

[02:07:16] And the committee relies upon the expertise and the internal review of the subject matter expert team to be thorough and thoughtful to ensure compliance with all applicable state and federal laws.

[02:07:33] And we're gonna go to the back to the other side. - The previous one. - Not this one. They got a little out of water, my apologies. So two other things we want to highlight in our review process that we believe really help ensure that we have high-quality applications. The first is that at any point in this process, both the Virginia Department of Education as well as the standing committees are available to provide technical assistance, support to applicants to assist them in the process, to advise them on the requirements of the law and to share guidance or other information as it has been considered by other applicants in the process.

[02:08:12] In fact, five of our seven thus far considered applicants have actually utilized onsite technical assistance visits to help support their application consideration.

[02:08:28] The second element that we have added into this process, and we're so happy when I see Susan Williams on the Zoom call, she's not up right now for the screen, I can see, but I know she's there, is that the Office of the Attorney General is also working in alignment with the Virginia Department of Education and concurrently helping review applications as they come in through the process and along the process.

[02:08:55] So the Office of Attorney General is reviewing the applications through the process. And if an application is affirmatively approved the state board of education the office of attorney general is also assisting with the contract review and ratification some of these elements go on behind the scenes and we just wanted to really surface those elements for the benefit of the public and for applicants to understand both the support that is available to them as to understand also why we have legal support throughout the process given all the requirements madam chair can i sit in more context please go

[02:09:31] Our work with the Office of the Attorney General is important because as you referenced today, there are distinct and unique statutes that relate to operating and establishing a college partnership lab school. Another dimension of our work has been to have the Office of the Attorney General begin to review applications and to make contact with counsel at the high rev partner earlier in the process, which will hopefully condense that 90-day statutorily required window we have to execute a contract from Board of Education approval in order to make this all

[02:10:07] happen prior to June 30, 2024. So they have been great partners and have taken on that work to ensure this move sufficiently. And we are so grateful for their support and engagement. And we, the committee, on behalf of the committee, I want to again thank the VDOE subject matter team and Dr. Armstrong, certainly your leadership, but all the members of the subject matter expert review process so we would not be here without their their deep knowledge of this and we know that this is an additional duty and they've really been hard at work one of the frequent updates that

[02:10:44] the committee also receives is our much beloved pipeline update this is quite the chart we have added to the chart our internal terms of art that we use such as when an application is submitted to THE VIRGINIA DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION, YOU SEE THAT IT IS NOW LISTED AS BEING UNDER REVIEW.

[02:11:05] WHEN IT COMES BEFORE THE STANDING COMMITTEE, IT IS LISTED AS PENDING. AND WE CAN SHOW -- SO THIS CHART KIND OF HELPS YOU TRACK. IN TOTAL, AS I INDICATED IN OUR OPENING REMARKS TO DATE, WE HAVE RECEIVED 21 APPLICATIONS IN TOTAL. I'M GOING TO HAVE YOU JUST GO FORWARD ONE SLIDE REAL QUICK. WE HAVE RECEIVED 21 APPLICATIONS IN TOTAL. FOUR APPLICATIONS. I'M GOING TO GIVE you the verbal summary here just because it's we toggle back and forth between the two so we always like to make sure you have the visual as well as a written summary but we have four applications

[02:11:41] that have been withdrawn thus far we have four applications that have been approved including the virginia commonwealth university germana community college university mary washington and james madison university today the committee considered three pending applications and there remain 10 additional applications to be reviewed that are currently under review by VDOE. And Dr.

[02:12:04] Armstrong, would you like to go back to this prior slide and provide us with some additional insight into these particular applications for both the committee as well as the public? Certainly, Madam Chair, and thank you to the members of the committee and for all of our partners who have submitted their applications. And as mentioned, we continue to do whatever we can to expedite this work with our subject matter expert team but at the same time ensuring that our applications that eventually we hope make it in front of the board are quality are sustainable are durable in the

[02:12:38] long term and and with that though we're operating in a fairly compressed timeline we have until june 30th this year to obligate our college partnership lab school 100 billion dollar grant fund and as you can see here a lot of this as this pipeline update has evolved we've added more detail around that funding. We have found that I think we're in the enviable position of really having more interest right now than we do have funds on that. And so we have had to ensure that we're prioritizing applications based on their date of submission and really working with

[02:13:16] a recent influx as we approach this deadline of applications. As Ms. Wadiska noted, we do have 10 applications that are still under video we review so for the folks who are who are here today who took the initiative and took the risk really to to do this earlier rather than later um i i commend you for for

being that brave to do so and um and that again shows the progress in green over there from left to right for you all relative to some of our other interested applicants or applicants that are currently in the pipeline we do have a handful of planning grant recipients who

[02:13:54] have yet to submit their applications um i am continuing to work with them to to get their application to a place where it can be submitted and considered for our agency's review with the subject matter expert team um but you can see the the bottom lines here where we have really outlined the beginning fund balance the total funds have been requested actually dr armstrong would you mind just moving mr bailey mr bailey we adore you unfortunately you're sitting right over the lines on money and so we're gonna move you to the side um over maybe just a little bit

[02:14:33] more to the if i go off videos anymore there we go thank you mr bailey i admire apologies but i know that everyone's very interested in seeing the fund balance the projected fund balance the current fund balance so i want to make sure that that information is available that's more important to me so thank you and and you can and you can see that here i will note that we've received guys this has come up in conversation standing committee before that the any funds that are remaining in our lab school planning grant fund can be moved into the operational pool of money this 100 million dollars has been separated into two kind of three distinct buckets which has been

[02:15:10] planning grant five million dollars 20 20 million dollars of startup money and then the remaining 75 for the operational funds so we will be able to make some shifts within that greater fund as we work to accommodate these requests but those 10 applications in a review you can see what has been requested i expected that as we move forward some of those requests will change as budgets are uh deliberated and scrutinized and whittled down to to make sure that we're doing this in a way that that is uh in accordance with our expectations as a agency as a committee and

[02:15:47] the committee will update this chart in light of today's consideration we will provide a more updated version of it to our website we have a website where we periodically provide updates again though given interest we'll make sure that this one is updated quickly put back up for public usage and every time that there's a an application submitted a new version of this chart is procured and we can provide this in real time if necessary to anyone who's interested

[02:16:20] am i correct in assuming that the column that's the the last column is the one that potentially could be impacted by current amended legislation at the uh at the state level in general assembly that is our understanding yes thank you according to our thus far based on the four lab schools that have been recommended by this committee and approved by the state board of education we show

[02:16:57] a total state funding award would be approximately 31 million okay thank you and then if you were to mind share integrate into that number those that are currently pending then you see there it comes out to closer to to 50 million dollars we did not know the outcome of today's deliberation so we included a pending line um and we will update this in in accordance with the deliberation that was conducted today by the committee so for everyone who's looking at this know that these numbers need

[02:17:35] to be updated based on the today's committee consideration okay um i think we have as part of our slide deck for those who may be interested we have quickly summarized the lab schools that have been approved thus far to date including vcu germano community college as well as university mary washington and james madison university in addition we have put together a little chart that summarizes the number of students that would be served by year because we are both visual learners

[02:18:14] as well as love lovers of reading we provided a graphic for where lab school applications have come in from red indicates those that are approved and when we say approved again it does not mean approved solely by the standing committee we are here to advise the state board it means that the state board has approved those applications we can see where green is submitted and then uh or the green excuse me is currently under review and blue indicates those who received

[02:18:49] additional planning grant support lastly we've also put together because again we're receiving a number of information requests a list of the school divisions public school divisions that would be served by approved and pending lab school applications again this chart will need to be updated in light of today's consideration but this it was as of the development of this agenda this includes the school divisions public school divisions that would be included in as partners

[02:19:25] in the public lab schools and is there anything dr armstrong that you would like to further add nothing further madam chair i feel we've even through the course of our discussions today with our presentations i think we've really touched on a lot of this and appreciate your leadership and i'm happy to answer any questions as well thank you we talk about a lot about team virginia on this work right now and it really does take a big team a lot of folks both on the committee the state board of education virginia department of education and most of all the applicants themselves it really requires a team to get through the application process and to work with partners

[02:20:03] so with that i'm now going to move on to item e which is the virginia lab schools and innovation network dr armstrong will be presenting this item right thank you madam chair get that i'm pleased to be joined today by Dr. Dave Myers. And Dr. Myers is my supervisor. He is the Deputy Superintendent of Data Research and Technology at Virginia Department of Education. We have worked together in a few different roles, I'd say for the better part of 20 years actually, even some local school

[02:20:41] divisions. And he has been, as you saw, he's a member of our subject matter expert team, is really there to help support our work in the agency with our lab schools. And I especially want to join us today in order to provide some additional detail about our work to establish networks of innovation here in the commonwealth and this has been a this is now standing agenda item that we have and one point that was brought up early on this conversation was really the first step has to be how do we inventory all the innovative programming happening here in the virginia and that doesn't include just our lab schools even though we're going to integrate lab

[02:21:18] schools into this it also includes our regional centers our ct centers any any option of i guess what's the best phrase for this dr meyer's choice choice the student has in virginia that might not be the comprehensive school to which they are assigned by enrollment address we want to capture that in a transparent uh visible visualization that's available to the public and then use this information to really establish our network i mean you've got to have an address book before you start to send out your invitations and this is kind of our address book for innovation network

[02:21:53] so this will be eventually and it is still beta i would say we're refining data but i've got dr myers here who i think really the best thing to do would be to have him jump on here and test drive it for you and just and you all this is a very special occasion because you're actually i think the first uh yeah question the first group that has had a chance to see this visualization it's run through the tableau interface and I think it's down below there. This is a much anticipated presentation for the committee. We have been talking about an inventory. We know that Virginia

[02:22:32] has a long history of innovation in public education and we really wanted to build upon that history and create an ecosystem where schools can collaborate, support one another, learn from each other and we really wanted to know where are those schools how many do we have and so this has been a conversation that the committee has been having probably for almost 18 months now and uh this is our first opportunity to see this dashboard about as long as you've been doing this work yeah um one of the things that we've done over the last couple of years at the

[02:23:10] DOE is is we started dashboarding a lot of things and it's been pretty exciting we have some folks that have become pretty uh pretty proficient at using a bi tool like tableau and this is one that lisa coons and i talked about a few months ago of looking at putting together and that is how do we track what kind of choices a student has outside of the traditional classroom and one of the things that really prompted that was just the beginning of this year looking at lab schools and thinking about what what opportunities um lab schools are going to present but there are also hundreds of

[02:23:49] other opportunities that students have and we had for the history of the the video we've never really had a clear picture of what that looks like i mean we know these regional centers exist here and this governor's school here so lab schools was the impetus to kind of really put this all together in a dashboard so what we did and i apologize because i don't have the screen here so i'm going have to lean around here and try to try to work my way around looking at what you're what you're looking at here what you have right here is the total enrollment of students in virginia 1.26

[02:24:23] million students we have 66 regional centers across the state and that serves 10 309 students and you can see it's a little less than one percent of our students i personally i think that's great that we have these regional centers i've been a part of them i know dr moran you've been part of these regional centers as a former superintendent um and they're fantastic and you can see them all here dotted across the across the state um but what that didn't tell us is everything about choices that students have and i will get to that in just a moment again lab schools are not here

[02:25:02] yet because they will be when we get them here and if there are other things that we want to display about lab schools we will be able to do so but for right now you can see here i can i can go over here and apologize it's a really clunky way to be able to do this because you can't see very well but i'm going to take an example here um i'm in the richmond area i used to be a superintendent in the richmond area and i oversaw maggie walker governor so can you see here it is right here yes okay so i'm just going to use that as an example i pull this up here um this will show you here it

[02:25:38] It will show you all the school divisions that belong to Maggie Walker's that are part of it, it will tell you this the enrollment of the 15 or 16 school divisions that are part of it. It will tell you how big this particular Center is right now and it will tell you what percent of the region students are being served at that school will also tell you.

[02:25:59] It should tell you here exactly how many students are from each of those centers and what the percentage of that make up that that Center. so it really gives you an insight to maggie walker here's who attends here's what it serves here's here's what it's doing and you know that's one of 66 centers um i can show you another one here just real briefly um because i know the morning is running long here i'm going to clear i'm going to take us down to bridging communities where is that one i'm going to hit this and hit

[02:26:35] that often sorry it's tricky on the angle yeah um so if i do this and this one's a little bit different um i happened to at one time be a superintendent in new kent county and so i know this center really well

and um there are six school divisions that belong to this center which i really would have done this different right now it's not a drive like this but these are the these are the schools that belong to this um regional tech center now i will tell you if this is this is being streamed and we said this was beta um there's something happening with our

[02:27:13] data pool here i know these numbers aren't quite right because i know the numbers and so our team is working on this before this goes live but this gives you an idea of who is served at this at this center the percentage of students at that center but as i said just a few moments ago um i really what i was worried about when i met with dr coons about this was this is great but having been both annie and i spent a long time in henrico county at one time we worked in that same locality together and i can tell you henrico has a really large robust specialty center um program all the high schools have one some have as many as three specialty centers that you can attend they have

[02:27:51] tech centers that you can attend that are half-day tech centers and real specific programs they have so many different opportunities that are not shown in a in a in a regional center like this so i give an example i have a child who's at college now but she attended the school in henrico county and went to a specialty center it was a choice program that she had to go to um and so what we did is we surveyed all of um we surveyed all of the school

[02:28:24] divisions and we asked them to tell us um gosh i'm going to scoot around here so i can actually look at this control drive instead of doing that um i'm gonna i'm gonna do something a little bit different i'm gonna pick on album wall does anybody in the room know anything about album maybe just a few people although they've continued to evolve yeah i was at their i was at their technical center that sits over here right outside of charlottesville last week phenomenal the stuff they were doing it was really really neat but if you go here um down to this oh um there are a few

[02:29:03] i probably shouldn't have done that there are a few i should have tested that that um we're still working on getting their data but since that's i'm sorry moran i'm not going to show you that one but i'm going to go back here to the one that i just mentioned a minute ago because i knew it very well um and that's just used in rica it was not getting from here and then rica is going to show you their enrollment right now is 50 464 i think it's our six or seven largest in the state um they have uh 6822 of those students are enrolled in specialty programs um and that means that

[02:29:42] 13.52 percent of their students are served in specialty programs that number is way different than one percent right or a little less than one percent so this shows henrico does have a very robust um setup like that but i will tell you that you can go here and i mentioned the the other work in ryco and new kent they get picked on all the time by me not being the data tonight but if you look um at new kent it will show they have 3536 students 2.77 so it's a smaller county they're not going to have as many people to be enrolled as many many but you know they do have multiple

[02:30:20] programs that students that can be a part of so anyway i just wanted to give you an idea of what this looks like and what we will be able to include with lab schools and if there's other information we're going to want to include about the centers that would be helpful to the public to see who's going there what's being offered there's all kinds of things that we can look at with so just wanted to take you on a little faster i love the dashboard we teed up a little bit of that data that you saw descriptions of lab schools and dr meyers correct i'm wrong but you'll be able to at at some point, hover over the lab school.

[02:30:52] - Yeah. - And then see, and kind of take this data and look at it differently, what students feed that lab school and then get the same overview just on a center level as well. - Well, we need to tie it to what they're studying at that lab school, what types of credentials students get coming out of that lab school, what, you know, there's all types of data that we can put there.

[02:31:12] Sky's kind of the limit on that. Well, the limit is really what you lacked in what you have. being obviously data collections take quite a bit I wonder how the data percentages would change given that many of these regional centers are totally focused on high school students that if you separate out elementary middle yeah from high school I bet you would would see a very different percentage even in a place like New Kent yeah and we could do that we haven't done that on this yet those self-reported so for instance in henrico county um where you saw they had a lot of

[02:31:49] special centers that included ip centers for middle school i think that included a couple gifted things for elementary so there were there are you could potentially drill down to that data absolutely yeah it's just it's just right now what we're working on is is building a collection that school divisions feed into what's called our student record collection or a master schedule collection these self-recorded programs are not built into that and so we're working on a way to get the student information system to automatically report that data of course so that that's when i say the sky is the limit the limit is really what black

[02:32:26] but we can build any dashboard we want to build and ultimately with me what this does is in providing these kind of data sets to the entire state is if i'm a superintendent and i'm in x division that I'm really interested in how do I get this kind of a program up and running in my high school or middle school I'll be able to see the Charlottesville piece and go oh let me reach out to and learn more about so I'm not reinventing the wheel well and that's why I think having some information that we drilled down into about what are they offering at the UVA you know

[02:33:04] at the Charlottesville UVA lab lab school I mean I just learned a little bit more this morning even about how they're going to how they're going to implement this lab right here the charlottesville city schools are with students using also uva students which i thought was really really neat just kind of talking that through so i'd love to be able to put that kind of information so people because uva doesn't have to be the only lab school that's being built to to build our teacher pipeline right or medical or whatever do you see the potential that school divisions would be able

[02:33:38] to upload some information to this site is that uh i don't know about that but they certainly we would have the ability to upload the information to us to feed so it wouldn't necessarily be to feed we we would we would validate all data before this is why this is live right now is because i can't quite validate the data but as soon as it's validated i love this yeah so if and you know we we have i'm going to put in a shameless plug really quickly here if you go to the doe web page there is a data page and we have it's called interactive dashboards there's a ton of

[02:34:14] them you want to know down to 54 different position types of how many vacancies we have and how many it's it's really really powerful stuff that you can start building with this kind of this is fantastic it's incredibly exciting to me if you can toggle back to out of the regional i i you have uh governor's schools some ct you have other categories right um from a mouse over here here

[02:34:45] we go uh let me go back here we want to go all the way back uh i was trying to do that without well back in march it's funny that i what i'm really excited about is the fact that our lab schools we know

they share a lot of the same themes with some of the ct centers and regional centers getting them connected and learning from each other is going to be important

[02:35:23] and this will help facilitate that exactly i mean part of the genesis of these conversations has been i'm sorry dr moran i have my back to you i'm trying to watch the screen and i have my back to you i'm in an impossible position here but we really wanted to have an inventory of we know dr moran and i know other committee members know there's really innovative programming going on in our public school system but we've never captured all of that and as we're thinking about building

[02:35:57] out and scaffolding an ecosystem of innovation and learning from one another and sharing right now it it's catch-as-catch-can sometimes yeah and i you know we really want to get more intentional to understand what is available and and to be able to share that information and so i just i'm really excited to see this it's been i'm sure a tremendous amount of work i'm appreciative that you've uh baited it here with us

[02:36:34] so what is so gracious of you and so brave i want to acknowledge that too um what i understand from kind of some of our conversations with the committee and the staff is i suspect that you would very much appreciate at some point some more feedback on this the public's engagement in it, is it accurate? Does it capture what you want to capture? Like, because we really want to build out something that's valuable, you know, tools to everyone. It includes, like, there were superintendents here today who might have some really fantastic program that's not included, right? So other dashboards, we've done that, we've gone out to the field, and we've really tried to

[02:37:10] get some feedback on that. So it's a great point. And if I may, you just summed up, like, I couldn't have summed up our purpose for doing this. We're trying to capture not only, you know, what we have, but then to try to spawn more innovation.

[02:37:26] So that's really, and there was just no way to even know in the state what kind of innovation we have going on. This is kind of the first attempt to do that. I mean, at some level, I've always said that every superintendent naturally has a strategic portfolio. Very few have an innovation portfolio.

[02:37:44] The state has a strategic portfolio. This becomes, I think, a place to put it in, in, what's the state's innovation, what's innovation portfolio that's right look and i'll share there's two other things that we've talked a little bit about um there's a huge value proposition in having not only more research but more information and sharing of practice across the profession and when you know dr moran was gracious and invited me to come and speak to valen one of the things i talked about there was

[02:38:23] it's important to be innovation amplifiers that if we look at for example the tech sector one of the things that they do to accelerate innovation and to share and scale is they have what's called innovation amplifiers and i think our superintendents or school board members the standing committee members so many individuals we're all micro versions of innovation amplifiers and information like this would afford us the opportunity to do that at a larger scale and if someone was to ask the simple question of hey what are some of the great things that you're

[02:39:01] doing in the commonwealth hey here's a chart you're here just here's a kind of a snapshot of what it is so i think we have a lot of things that we can and are very proud of in the commonwealth and um will benefit by connecting those elements together the last part of this when we were chatting all of the committee members and some of the other folks around the commonwealth one of the reasons we really

wanted it in a visual i'll never forget when we first put hunger data on a map for the commonwealth it was such a powerful moment for me because you could literally see where more

[02:39:38] resources were needed yeah those were people and i think what will be hopeful about a visual representation of this is we also want to know are there regions communities that need more support and and that's going to help us start to better understand where we can be a partner we use percentages in here yeah where you see a lot of gray you know you know there aren't many offerings and that's where you can focus your efforts when we just considered an application you saw that it was isolated down there exactly so thank you and thank you for coming to our

[02:40:16] meeting absolutely yeah yeah thank you yes andy and i actually work really closely behind the scenes together um like i'm very familiar with everything today i said i want to come be a part of it thank you thank you very much i do appreciate dr meyers being here and i think i've covered most of what we were going to cover in our slides and again i hope to stay on this pathway in this timeline to really get this debut hopefully this spring and then this summer take that and put in our lab schools make them part of this tableau as well and develop that network and think about

[02:40:52] KICKING THAT OFF IN SOME WAY SHAPE OR FORM THIS FALL. THAT'S WHERE WE'D LIKE TO BE. THANK YOU, DR. ARMSTRONG. ALL RIGHT. SO I DON'T THINK -- I THINK WE HAVE DISCUSSED ENOUGH TODAY. SO I'M NOT SURE THERE'S ANY MORE DISCUSSION OF CURRENT ISSUES. AND THERE ARE -- THERE'S NO PUBLIC COMMENT ON NON AGENDA ITEMS. SO AT THIS TIME, I WOULD JUST SHARE THAT THE COMMITTEE MEETS EVERY MONTH.

[02:41:15] WE TYPICALLY MEET THE FIRST MONDAY OF THE MONTH UNLESS THE MONDAY IS A HOLIDAY. THEN WE MOVE ON TO TUESDAY. BUT FOR THE NEXT THREE MEETINGS, THE COMMITTEE'S NEXT SCHEDULE MEETING WILL BE MONDAY, April 8th, Monday, May 6th, and Monday, June 3rd. That is the train. If you want to be on it, get your ticket. But those are the next three opportunities. So with that, we stand adjourned. Thank you very much. Awesome.

